Reporting Statements

We make the following changes when reporting the statements.

- Change the pronouns
- Reporting verb followed by 'that'
- Change the tense, time and place

(e.g.) Kowsalya said, "We watched a film yesterday."

Kowsalya said ***that they watched*** a film ***the day before***.

pronoun — tense — time

Reporting Imperatives

To report an imperative, use the pattern –

request/order/suggest + someone + to infinitive

(e.g.) Karthi said to Ram, "Please, switch on the fan."

Karthi requested Ram to switch on the fan.

Reporting Questions

When reporting questions, we use the pattern:

asked/ wanted to know + question word + pronoun + verb

(e.g.) She said to me, "Where did you go?"

She asked me where I went.

Note: *If the 'wh' question is missing, if or whether is added.*

(e.g.) Praveena asked, "Have you watered the plants?"

Praveena asked if/whether I had watered the plants.

Sometimes it is not necessary to report everything that is said word by word. It may be better to use 'reporting verbs' which summarise what was communicated.

Book 1.indb 186 21-01-2020 17:29:21